Iteration F4: Broadcasting Updates with Action Cable

As we saw with the products index page in *Iteration A3: Making the Page Update in Real Time*, it's possible to send information from our Rails app to our users' browsers without a direct request. The technology that enables this is called WebSockets.[61] Prior to Rails 5, setting this up was fairly involved, but Rails 5 introduced Action Cable, which simplifies pushing data to all connected browsers.

We can use Action Cable and WebSockets to broadcast price updates to the users browsing the catalog. To see why we'd want to, bring up the Depot application in two browser windows or tabs. In the first window, display the catalog. Then, in the second window, update the price of an item. Return to the first window and add that item to the cart. At this point, the cart shows the updated price, but the catalog shows the original price, as illustrated in the screenshot.

